

QUEENSLAND INDUSTRIAL RELATIONS COMMISSION

Matter No. WC/2024/227 | Cory Lea Shepherd (Appellant) v Workers' Compensation Regulator (Respondent)

OUTLINE OF EVIDENCE – MS PATRICIA CONAGHAN

Served pursuant to direction 2 of the Further Directions Order (3) dated 19 August 2026. Not filed in the Industrial Registry.

Ms Conaghan is employed by Metro South Hospital and Health Service as [position] at Logan Hospital Switchboard. She has worked in that department since [month/year] and worked alongside the Appellant throughout the period [month/year] to [month/year].

1. On 7 August 2023 the Appellant wrote to Ms Taylor, Ms Reese, Ms Conaghan and Ms Smith recording that Ms Conaghan and the Appellant each wished to take on an additional two shifts per fortnight. Ms Conaghan will confirm that she and the Appellant sought those additional hours.
2. Following the changes made to the Switchboard process, urgent pathology results for clinical staff were delayed in reaching the treating team. [Ms Conaghan to describe what she observed — what the process was before, what it became, and the delay that resulted.]
3. Between 2 and 8 May 2024 there were occasions on which calls were connected to the wrong medical team, including calls concerning emergency responses. [Ms Conaghan to describe what she observed at the console during that period.]
4. During that period operators had no means of correcting an incorrect entry in the directory themselves.
5. Ms Conaghan was not consulted about the change to after-hours on-call arrangements notified by Ms Taylor to the Switchboard on 15 April 2024, and was not asked to vote on that change.
6. Ms Conaghan was not consulted about, and was not balloted in relation to, changes to the Switchboard roster before [date].
7. [If applicable: Ms Conaghan to describe any changes she observed in the Appellant at work over the period, limited to her own observation.]
8. Ms Conaghan was endorsed as a workplace delegate of Together Queensland on or about 3 November 2025, at the same time as the Appellant and Ms Jeffrey.

This outline is a summary of the evidence the witness is expected to give. It is not a statement of the witness and is not signed by the witness.